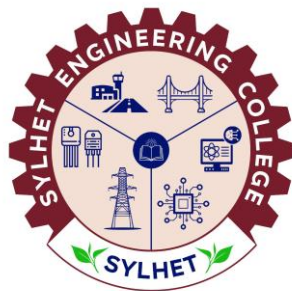


Undergraduate Thesis Formatting

First Edition: August, 2025



Department of Civil Engineering
Sylhet Engineering College, Sylhet-3100, Bangladesh.

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1.1 Paper Size

Use A4 paper (210 × 297 mm or 8.27 × 11.69 inches) for all pages.

1.2 Font Style and Size

All content—including body text, page numbers, figure and table captions, references, and footnotes—must use the same font throughout. The font size should generally be 12 points for body text. Headings may be slightly larger and the font size should generally be 14. Consistency in font type and size is essential, though adjustments can be made for symbols or scientific notation when necessary.

1.3 Line Spacing

Text should be spaced 1.5 lines throughout the document, including the references. Long quotations, section titles, captions, footnotes, and endnotes can be single-spaced. Use the same spacing style consistently.

1.4 Margins

- Left margin: 1.5 inches
- Right, top, and bottom margins: 1 inch each

Avoid ending a page with just one line from a paragraph or continuing a paragraph with only one line on the next page. Make sure at least two lines of a paragraph appear together at the top or bottom of a page. All tables, figures, and their captions must also follow the margin rules.

1.5 Page Numbering

Number all pages that contain text, figures, or tables.

- Use lowercase Roman numerals (i, ii, iii, ...) for the preliminary pages (e.g., acknowledgements, abstract, table of contents etc.).
- Begin Arabic numerals (1, 2, 3, ...) from the first page of Chapter 1. Page numbers should be centered at the bottom of each page, half an inch from the edge, and must match the font and size used in the main text. Note: Although the front page and title page is considered page "i, ii," the number itself is not displayed.

2. Content Structure Guidelines

The thesis should be organized in the following order:

1. Front Page
2. Title Page
3. Declaration Page
4. Certification Page [if have both supervisor and co-supervisor]
5. Certification Page [if have only a supervisor]
6. Copyright Statement Page
7. Acknowledgement
8. Table of Contents
9. List of Figures
10. List of Tables
11. List of Symbols, Abbreviations, Nomenclature, or Glossary
12. Abstract
13. Main Body – Chapters [including text, tables, figures, and equations]
14. References
15. Appendices (if needed)

2.1 Front Page

The **title page is mandatory** and must include the following: [see next page]

**TITLE OF THE THESIS/PROJECT IS CENTERED 14 POINT BOLD,
UPPERCASE**

A Thesis [CE 400]

by

Author's Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

Author's Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

Author's Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

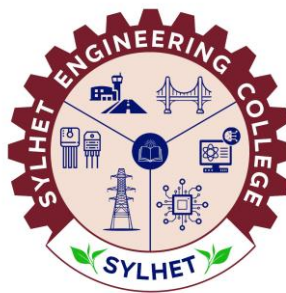
12 pt font – 1
spacing

1.5 line spacing

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN CIVIL ENGINEERING

12 pt font
capital

12 pt font - 6
spacing



Logo Size
1.7'' x 1.7''

DEPARTMENT OF CIVIL ENGINEERING

SYLHET ENGINEERING COLLEGE

SYLHE-3100, BANGLADESH

MONTH, YEAR

12 pt font - 1
spacing

2.2 Title Page

- See this in the next page. **Do not list this page in the Table of Contents.**

**TITLE OF THE THESIS/PROJECT IS CENTERED 14 POINT BOLD,
UPPERCASE**

12 pt font – 2
spacing

by

Author's Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

Author's Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

Author's Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

1.5 line spacing

A thesis submitted to the Department of Civil Engineering in partial fulfillment for
the degree of

1.5 line spacing

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN CIVIL ENGINEERING

12 pt font capital

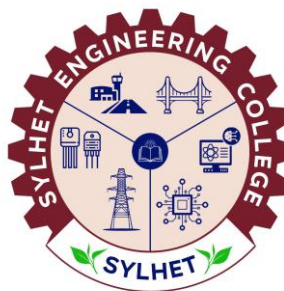
At the

SYLHET ENGINEERING COLLEGE

12 pt font capital

[Affiliated with Sylhet University of Science and Technology (SUST), Sylhet]

12 pt font - 5
spacing



Logo Size
1.7'' x 1.7''

DEPARTMENT OF CIVIL ENGINEERING

SYLHET ENGINEERING COLLEGE

SYLHE-3100, BANGLADESH

12 pt font - 1
spacing

MONTH, YEAR

2.3 Declaration

- The heading “**DECLARATION**” must be in **bold, all capital letters**, and its **font size should be 14 points**.
- It must be **centered** horizontally at **the top** of the page.
- The content starts **three single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Maintain the same **line spacing** (1.5) as used in the rest of the thesis.
- The page must include a **lowercase Roman numeral** as its page number, centered in the **footer, 0.5 inches from the bottom**.
- **List this page in the Table of Contents.**

DECLARATION

12 pt font – 2
spacing



I hereby declare that this thesis/project is the result of my own independent work, and to the best of my knowledge, it contains no material previously published or written by another person, nor has it been submitted for the award of any degree at Sylhet Engineering College (SEC) or any other academic institution, except where proper acknowledgment has been made. This thesis was carried out by us under the supervision of [Supervisor's Name].

I further affirm that the intellectual content of this work is entirely my own. Any contributions to the research by collaborators at this college or elsewhere have been clearly acknowledged.

12 pt font - 3
spacing



Signature

Name & Reg.

12 pt font - 5
spacing



Signature

Name & Reg.

12 pt font - 5
spacing



Signature

Name & Reg.

2.4 Certification [if have both supervisor and Co-supervisor]

- The heading “**CERTIFICATION**” must be in **bold, all capital letters**, and its **font size should be 14 points**.
- It must be **centered** horizontally at **the top** of the page.
- The content starts **two single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Maintain the same **line spacing** (1.5) as used in the rest of the thesis.
- The page must include a **lowercase Roman numeral** as its page number, centered in the **footer, 0.5 inches from the bottom**.
- **List this page in the Table of Contents.**

CERTIFICATION

12 pt font – 2
spacing

TITLE OF THE THESIS/PROJECT IS CENTERED **12 POINT BOLD,**
UPPERCASE

by

12 pt font – 1
spacing

Author’s Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word
Author’s Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word
Author’s Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

1.5 line spacing

A thesis submitted to the Department of Civil Engineering in partial fulfillment for
the degree of

1.5 line spacing

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN CIVIL ENGINEERING

12 pt font capital

At the

SYLHET ENGINEERING COLLEGE

12 pt font capital

[Affiliated with Sylhet University of Science and Technology (SUST), Sylhet]

12 pt font – 2
spacing

APPROVED AS TO STYLE AND CONTENT BY:

Co Supervisor Name
info
XXXXXXXXXXXX,
Sylhet-3100

1.5 line spacing

Supervisor Name
info
YYYYYYYYYYYY,
Sylhet-3100

2.5 Certification [if have only a supervisor]

- The heading “**CERTIFICATION**” must be in **bold, all capital letters**, and its **font size should be 14 points**.
- It must be **centered** horizontally at **the top** of the page.
- The content starts **two single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Maintain the same **line spacing** (1.5) as used in the rest of the thesis.
- The page must include a **lowercase Roman numeral** as its page number, centered in the **footer, 0.5 inches from the bottom**.
- **List this page in the Table of Contents.**

CERTIFICATION

12 pt font – 2
spacing

TITLE OF THE THESIS/PROJECT IS CENTERED **12 POINT BOLD,**
UPPERCASE

by

12 pt font – 1
spacing

Author’s Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word
Author’s Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word
Author’s Name (Reg) 12 Point Capitalize Each Word

1.5 line spacing

A thesis submitted to the Department of Civil Engineering in partial fulfillment for
the degree of

1.5 line spacing

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN CIVIL ENGINEERING

12 pt font capital

At the

SYLHET ENGINEERING COLLEGE

12 pt font capital

[Affiliated with Sylhet University of Science and Technology (SUST), Sylhet]

12 pt font – 2
spacing

APPROVED AS TO STYLE AND CONTENT BY:

Supervisor Name

info

YYYYYYYYYYY,

Sylhet-3100

1.5 line spacing

2.6 Copyright statement

- The heading “**COPYRIGHT STATEMENT**” must be in **bold, all capital letters**, and its **font size should be 14 points**.
- It must be **centered** horizontally at **the top** of the page.
- The content starts **two single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Maintain the same **line spacing** (1.5) as used in the rest of the thesis.
- The page must include a **lowercase Roman numeral** as its page number, centered in the **footer, 0.5 inches from the bottom**.
- **List this page in the Table of Contents.**

COPYRIGHT STATEMENT

12 pt font – 2
spacing

1.5 line
spacing

The author hereby grants to DEPARTMENT OF CIVIL ENGINEERING, Sylhet Engineering College, Sylhet-3100, Bangladesh, a nonexclusive, worldwide, irrevocable, royalty-free license to exercise any and all rights under copyright, including to reproduce, preserve, distribute and publicly display copies of the thesis, or release the thesis under an open-access license.

12 pt font – 2
spacing

Signature of Student: _____

Name (Reg)

Department of Civil engineering

Date:

1.5 line spacing @ All

12 pt font – 1
spacing

Signature of Student: _____

Name (Reg)

Department of Civil engineering

Date:

12 pt font – 1
spacing

Signature of Student: _____

Name (Reg)

Department of Civil engineering

Date:

12 pt font – 2
spacing

Certified and Accepted by: _____

Name and info

Thesis Supervisor

12 pt font – 1
spacing

Certified and Accepted by: _____

Name and info

Thesis Co-Supervisor

If have only a supervisor then remove Co-Supervisor portion.

2.7 Acknowledgement

This section offers a chance to express gratitude and appreciation.

- The heading “**ACKNOWLEDGMENT**” must be in **bold, all caps**, with a **font size 14 points**.
- It must be **centered** horizontally at **the top** of the page.
- The content starts **two single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Maintain the same **line spacing** (1.5) as used in the rest of the thesis.
- The page must include a **lowercase Roman numeral** as its page number, centered in the **footer, 0.5 inches from the bottom**.
- Use only a single page.
- **List this page in the Table of Contents.**

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

12 pt font – 2
spacing



First and foremost, praises and thanks to the almighty, Allah, for His showers of blessings throughout my research work to complete the research successfully.

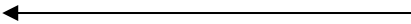
I would like to express my deep and sincere gratitude to my research supervisor.....

.....
.....

1.5 line spacing

Last but not the least, I am extremely grateful to my parents for their love, prayers, caring and sacrifices for educating and preparing me for my future.

12 pt font – 3
spacing



Sylhet
Month, Year

Student Name (reg)
Student Name (reg)
Student Name (reg)

2.8 Table of Content

Generate a **Table of Contents (TOC)** using the **References tab** in Microsoft Word.

Step 1: Apply Heading Styles

You **must apply Word's built-in Heading styles** to the chapters and sections you want in your TOC.

1. Select your **chapter title** (e.g., "Chapter 1: Introduction").
2. Go to the **Home tab**.
3. In the **Styles** group, click on **Heading 1**.
 - Use **Heading 1** for main chapters.
 - Use **Heading 2** for sub-sections (e.g., 1.1 Background).
 - Use **Heading 3** for sub-subsections (e.g., 1.1.1 Purpose).

Repeat for all headings in your document.

Step 2: Insert the Table of Contents

1. Place the cursor after '**ACKNOWLEDGEMENT**' Page for the TOC.
2. Go to the **References** tab.
3. Click on **Table of Contents** (leftmost button).
4. Choose a **built-in style** (e.g., Automatic Table 1 or 2) or click **Custom Table of Contents...** for more options.
5. Click **OK**.

Step 3: Customize (if needed)

If you choose **Custom Table of Contents...**:

- You can:
 - Change how many heading levels to include (1–3 recommended for theses).
 - Choose whether to show page numbers.
 - Align page numbers (usually right-aligned).
- Click **OK** when satisfied.

Step 4: Update the TOC (as you write)

Anytime you **add, remove, or edit** headings:

1. Click on the Table of Contents.

2. Press **F9**, or right-click and choose **Update Field**.
3. Select:
 - **Update page numbers only** (for small edits).
 - **Update entire table** (if headings changed).

Notes for Writing:

- Make sure your **chapter titles** and **section headings** are consistent in format.
- Use **Heading 1** only for chapters (not everything). [Ensure Font name and size]
- Don't manually type the TOC — always use the automatic one for easier updates and formatting.

2.9 List of Figures

This section lists all figures included in the thesis.

- The heading “**LIST OF FIGURES**” must be in **bold, all capital letters**, and the **font size should be 14 points and follow the modify Heading style**. **Also, you can use adding new style for this specific heading “LIST OF FIGURES”**.
- It should be **centered horizontally at the top** of the page.
- Begin listing the figures **three single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.

To **caption a figure** in Microsoft Word and make it appear in the **List of figures**, follow these step-by-step instructions:

Step 1: Insert a Caption for the Figure

1. **Click on the figure** (image, chart, graph, etc.) that you want to caption.
2. Go to the **References** tab in the top ribbon.
3. Click on **Insert Caption** (within the "Captions" group).
4. In the dialog box:
 - **Label:** Select **Figure** from the dropdown menu.
 - **Caption:** Type a meaningful title for your figure after the label (e.g., Figure 1.1: Stress-Strain Curve of Steel).
 - **Position:** Choose **Below selected item** (standard for figures).
 - Click **OK**.

Repeat for all figures in your document.

Step 2: Use Consistent Figure Labels (Optional)

If needed, click on **New Label** in the Caption dialog box to define custom labels, though for academic work, stick with "Figure" to maintain consistency.

Step 3: Generate the List of Figures

1. Place the cursor where you want to insert the **List of Figures** (After the Table of Contents).
2. Go to the **References** tab.
3. Click on **Insert Table of Figures**.

4. In the dialog box:
 - **Caption label:** Ensure **Figure** is selected.
 - Choose a formatting style (you may preview them).
 - Click **OK**.

Step 4: Update the List of Figures

Whenever you add, delete, or modify captions:

1. Click on the List of Figures.
2. Press **F9**, or right-click and select **Update Field**.
3. Choose:
 - **Update page numbers only** (if locations changed).
 - **Update entire table** (if new figures were added or captions changed).

For Best Practices

- Place figure captions **below** the figure.
- Number figures logically (e.g., Figure 2.3 for Chapter 2, etc.).

2.10 List of Tables

This section lists all the tables used in the thesis.

- The heading “**LIST OF TABLES**” must be in **bold uppercase letters, 14 points, and centered horizontally.**
- Start listing table captions **three single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin.**

Guide to caption a **table** in Microsoft Word and generate a **List of Tables**, suitable for thesis writing:

Step 1: Apply a Caption to the Table

1. **Click on the table** you want to caption.
2. Go to the **References** tab in the top ribbon.
3. Click on **Insert Caption** (in the "Captions" group).
4. In the Caption dialog box:
 - **Label:** Choose **Table** from the dropdown.
 - **Caption:** Type a descriptive title after the label (e.g., Table 3.2: Summary of Test Results).
 - **Position:** Select **Above selected item** (tables are usually captioned above).
5. Click **OK**.

Repeat for each table in your document.

Step 2: Enable Multi-Level Numbering (e.g., Table 2.1, Table 3.1)

To number tables by chapter:

1. In the **Insert Caption** dialog box, click **Numbering...**
2. In the **Caption Numbering** window:
 - Check “**Include chapter number**”.
 - Set **Chapter starts with style:** Select **Heading 1**.
 - Choose a **separator** (e.g., period: Table 2.1).
3. Click **OK**, then again **OK** to finish inserting the caption.

Step 3: Generate the List of Tables

1. Place the cursor where you want the **List of Tables** (After the List of Figures).
2. Go to the **References** tab.
3. Click on **Insert Table of Figures**.
4. In the dialog box:
 - **Caption label:** Select **Table**.
 - Choose desired format and appearance.
5. Click **OK** to insert the List of Tables.

Step 4: Update the List of Tables

Anytime you add, delete, or move a table:

1. Click on the List of Tables.
2. Press **F9**, or right-click and choose **Update Field**.
3. Select:
 - **Update page numbers only**, or
 - **Update entire table** (recommended if captions changed).

For Best Practices

- Use **Heading 1** style for chapter titles to enable chapter-based numbering.
- Keep table captions **concise** but **descriptive**.
- Always place table captions **above the table**.
- Do **not type the list manually** — always use Word's auto-generation for accuracy.

2.11 List of Symbols, Abbreviations, Nomenclature, or Glossary

Include this section only if relevant to your thesis.

- The section heading (e.g., “**LIST OF SYMBOLS,**” “**ABBREVIATIONS,**” “**GLOSSARY,**” etc.) must be in **bold uppercase, 14 points**, and **centered** between the margins, placed **at the top** of the page.
- Begin the list **three single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Use **1.5 line spacing**, and apply the same spacing style consistently.
- This section should appear **after** the List of Tables
- Page numbers must use **lowercase Roman numerals**, centered **0.5 inches from the bottom** of the page in the **footer**.

2.12 Abstract

This section is **compulsory**.

- The abstract should not be longer 1 page.
- The heading “**ABSTRACT**” should be in **bold, uppercase letters**, and **14 points**.
- Center it horizontally on the page, placed **at the top**.
- Begin the abstract text **single-spaced lines below** the heading.

It should include:

- A clear statement outlining the research problem
- A concise overview of your research methodology
- A summary of the key results or findings

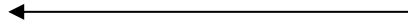
Avoid using mathematical equations, diagrams, or any illustrative elements in the abstract.

The abstract text should be **1.5 line spacing** and formatted consistently with the rest of the thesis.

The page number must use **lowercase Roman numerals**, placed **at the center of the footer, 0.5 inches from the bottom** of the page.

ABSTRACT

12 pt font – 1
spacing



Write abstract portion

2.13 Main Body of the Thesis

This section forms the **core of your thesis**, presenting your full research work.

- It follows all the preliminary pages.
- The content should follow a **clear, consistent, and logical structure** throughout all chapters and sections.
- Use a **standardized section numbering system**, with chapters, sections, and subsections numbered **sequentially** across the thesis.
- Page numbers must be in **Arabic numerals** (1, 2, 3, ...), **centered in the footer**, and placed **0.5 inches from the bottom** of each page.
- Example in the next page.

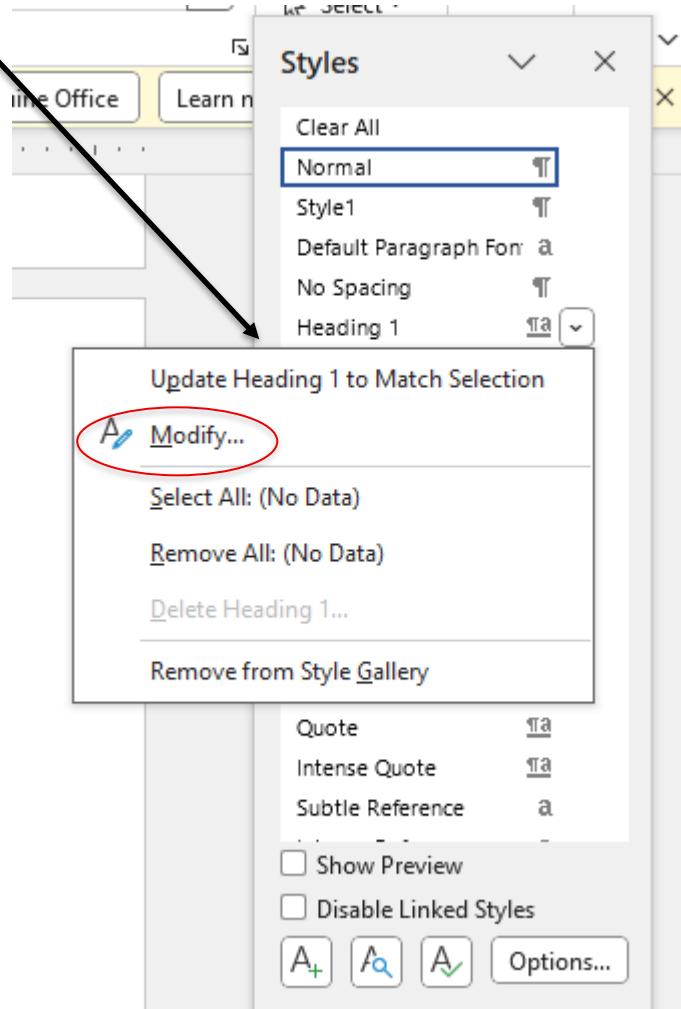
Chapter 1

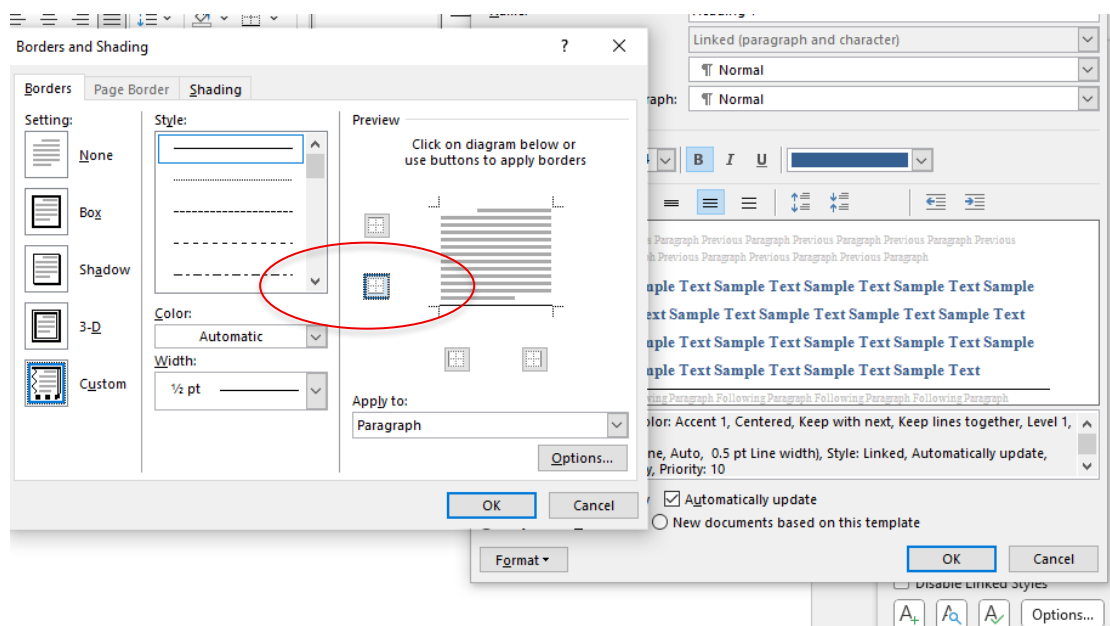
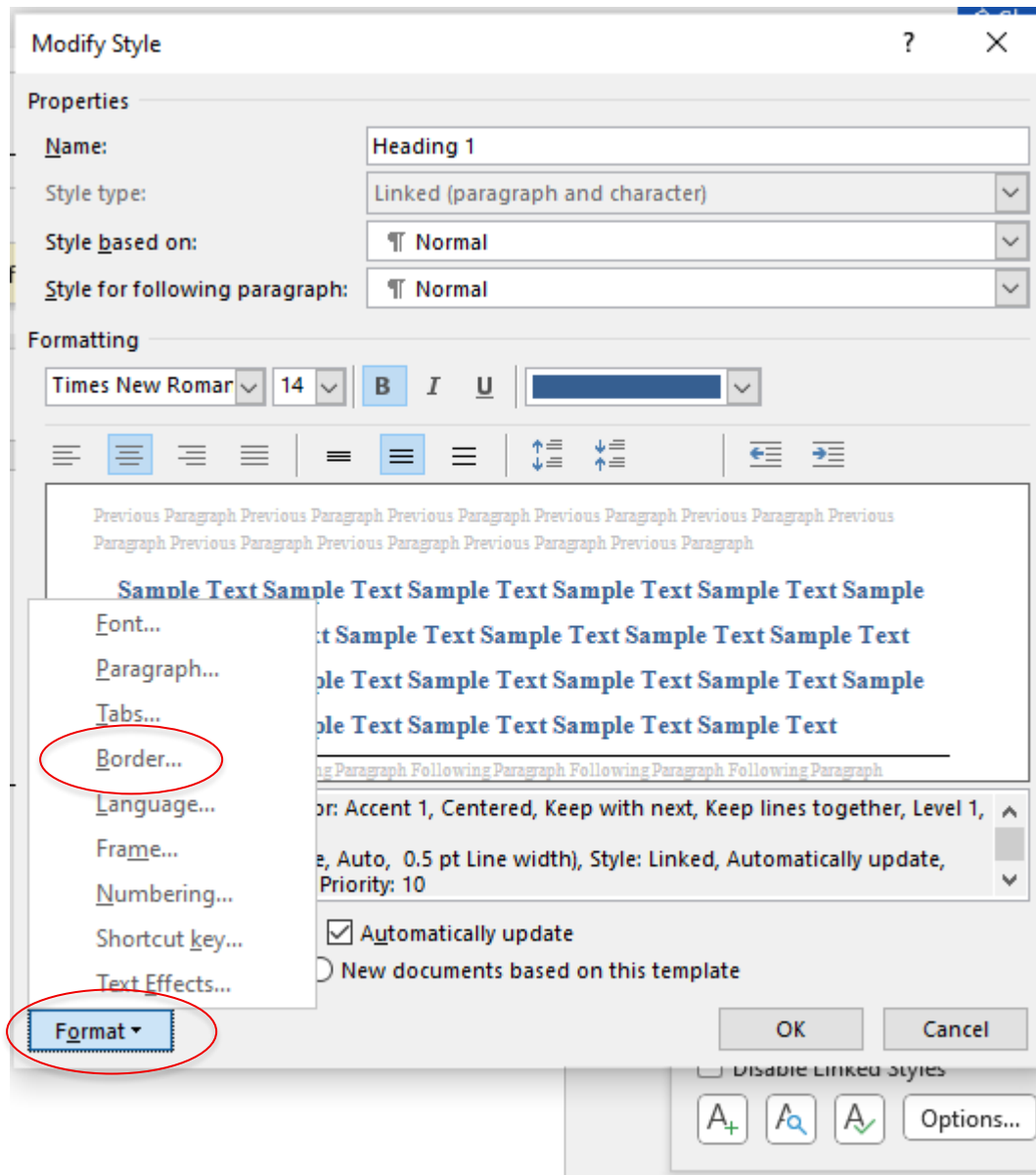
INTRODUCTION

Use Capital Letter

1.1 Background

For this line





2.14 References

The **References** section must be included in your thesis and should appear **before the Appendices**.

- The heading “**REFERENCES**” must be in **bold, all caps**, and **14 points**.
- It should be **centered between the margins** and placed **at the top** of the page.
- Begin the list **two single-spaced lines below** the heading, aligned to the **left margin**.
- Reference entries should be **single-spaced**, with a **hanging indent of 0.25 inches** for each first line, and a **blank line** between entries.

You may organize references in either:

- **Alphabetical order**, without numbering, or
- **Numerical order**, based on the **sequence of citations** in the text (with references numbered and enclosed in square brackets, e.g., [1], [2], etc.).

Use a recognized referencing style

- APA
- IEEE etc. and apply it **consistently throughout** the document.

For citation and references management, tools like

- **Mendeley**,
- **Zotero**, or
- **EndNote** etc. can assist in organizing references efficiently.

2.15 Appendices *(if needed)*

The **Appendix** section is optional and should be placed **after the References**.

- The heading “**APPENDIX**” must be in **bold capital letters, 14, and centered** between the margins.
- It should appear **at the top** of the page.
- Appendices can include **supporting data, original research materials, computer code, large tables**, or any **supplementary content** that doesn’t fit well in the main text.
- The word **APPENDIX** should be listed in the **Table of Contents** as a primary heading.
- Figures and tables in the appendix must be clearly **numbered and captioned**, following the same formatting rules as in the main body.
- Appendices can be divided into Appendix A, B, C.
- Page numbers must continue in **Arabic numerals**, centered **0.5 inch from the bottom of the page**.